

Tracking the **TIGER KILLERS**

An exclusive, undercover sting to enter the world of India's notorious poaching tribes and gauge their motivation and modus operandi

They are the people responsible for India's iconic animal being threatened with extinction, a tragedy of unimaginable proportions. Two nomadic hunting tribes, along with corrupt or incompetent forest officials, continue to hunt the tiger in its natural habitat using primitive traps. The result is that tiger population figures have registered an all-time low. India has lost two-thirds of its tigers in the last eight years. Driven by greed and the money they can earn by selling tiger skin and parts to the Chinese market, India's most notorious poachers are decimating tiger populations virtually unchecked. Sariska and Panna have lost all their tigers to poaching even as forest officials feign ignorance. Principal Correspondent MIHIR SRIVASTAVA has been on the trail of the poachers to identify the main culprits, their modus operandi, their buyers and the havoc



PARDHIS WITH THE TIGER PARTS SEIZED IN ALLAHABAD IN 2007

Photograph courtesy: WPSI

they have already caused among India's tiger population. His report:

The Pardhis and Bawariyas are nomadic hunting tribes who travel across the country